

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Advanced Math	Nonlinear functions	Medium

Question

$f(x) = \frac{a-19}{x} + 5$

In the given function f , a is a constant. The graph of function f in the xy -plane, where $y = f(x)$, is translated **3** units down and **4** units to the right to produce the graph of $y = g(x)$. Which equation defines function g ?

Answer

- A. $g(x) = \frac{a-19}{x+4} + 2$
- B. $g(x) = \frac{a-19}{x-4} + 2$
- C. $g(x) = \frac{a-22}{x+4} + 5$
- D. $g(x) = \frac{a-22}{x-4} + 5$

Correct Answer: B

Rationale

Choice B is correct. It's given that the graph of $y = g(x)$ is produced by translating the graph of $y = f(x)$ **3** units down and **4** units to the right in the xy -plane. Therefore, function g can be defined by an equation in the form $g(x) = f(x - 4) - 3$. Function f is defined by the equation $f(x) = \frac{a-19}{x} + 5$, where a is a constant. Substituting $x - 4$ for x in the equation $f(x) = \frac{a-19}{x} + 5$ yields $f(x - 4) = \frac{a-19}{x-4} + 5$. Substituting $\frac{a-19}{x-4} + 5$ for $f(x - 4)$ in the equation $g(x) = f(x - 4) - 3$ yields $g(x) = \frac{a-19}{x-4} + 5 - 3$, or $g(x) = \frac{a-19}{x-4} + 2$. Therefore, the equation that defines function g is $g(x) = \frac{a-19}{x-4} + 2$.

Choice A is incorrect. This equation defines a function whose graph is produced by translating the graph of $y = f(x)$ **3** units down and **4** units to the left, not **3** units down and **4** units to the right.

Choice C is incorrect. This equation defines a function whose graph is produced by translating the graph of $y = f(x)$ **4** units to the left, not **3** units down and **4** units to the right.

Choice D is incorrect. This equation defines a function whose graph is produced by translating the graph of $y = f(x)$ **4** units to the right, not **3** units down and **4** units to the right.